INCH-POUND

AA-C-571J
17 October 2025
SUPERSEDING
AA-C-571H
20 September 1993

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

COT, FOLDING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this federal specification by all federal agencies.

1. Scope

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for one type of aluminum frame folding cot (see 6.1 and 6.4).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Other Government Documents, Drawings, and Publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

U.S. ARMY COMBAT CAPABILITIES DEVELOPMENTCOMMAND SOLDIER CENTER DRAWINGS

2-5-72 – Cot, Folding; Assembly Complete

(Copies of these documents are available from U.S. Army Combat Capabilities Development Command Soldier Center 10 General Greene Ave. Natick, MA 01760 or https://devcom.army.mil.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR QUALITY (ASQ)

ASQ/ANSI-Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Copies of this document are available online at www.asq.org or the American Society for Quality, 611 East Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53202.)

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to DLA Troop Support – Construction and Equipment (C&E) (ATTN: Code FCSB), 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5098 or email to CE_Standardization@dla.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

AMSC N/A FSC 7105

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM-B633 - Standard Specification for Electrodeposited Coatings of Zinc on Iron and Steel
ASTM-D6193 - Standard Practice for Stitches and Seams

(Copies of this document are available from www.astm.org or the American Society for Testing and Materials, 100 Barr Harbor Drive, W. Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the reference cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2) a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.3) in accordance with 4.3.

3.2 Materials. Materials shall conform to the requirements specified herein and the subsidiary documents applicable thereto. Materials not definitely specified shall be of the quality normally used by the manufacturer for the frame and cover, provided the end item complies with all provisions of this specification. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of this specification.

3.2.1 Hardware, miscellaneous. Bolts, nuts and washers shall be steel, commercial quality, of the size and type shown on the drawings. Rivets shall be steel, commercial quality, semi-tubular or solid type, except the rivet used on the strap shall be brass of commercial quality, tubular, flathead, with brass cap. All steel miscellaneous hardware shall have a corrosion-resisting plating in accordance with manufacturer's commercial practice. The rivets shall be of sufficient length to provide a minimum of 0.125 inch for peening or rolling, as applicable. Blind rivets shall be aluminum, commercial type, 0.188 inch body, 0.625 inch head, break stem, large flange (see 6.5).

3.3 Construction. The construction of the cots shall conform in all respects to Drawing 2-5-72 and all subsidiary drawings pertaining thereto, and as specified herein. At the option of the contractor, covers shall be fabricated from either cotton duck or nylon duck. The cots shall be capable of being assembled, disassembled and compactly folded as intended without causing damage to any component.

3.3.1 Stitches, seams and stitching. Stitching shall conform to stitch type 301 of ASTM-D6193, with 8 to 10 stitches per inch.

3.3.1.1 Automatic stitching. Automatic stitching machines may be used to perform any of the required stitch patterns provided the requirements for the stitch pattern, stitches per inch, and size and type of thread are met; and at least three or more tying, overlapping or back stitches are used to secure the ends of stitching.

3.3.1.2 Type 301 stitching. Ends of all stitching shall be backstitched or overstitched not less than 1 inch except where ends are turned under or caught in other seams and stitching. Thread tensions shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be imbedded in the materials sewed.

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3.3.1.2.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during stitching, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting a minimum of 1 inch (0.500 inch for box-x stitching) back of the end of the stitching. 1/

b. Thread breaks, or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches noted during inspection of the item (in-process or end item) shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of 1 inch in back of the defective area (0.500 inch on box-x stitching), and continue over the defective area and continue a minimum of 1 inch (0.500 inch on box-x stitching) beyond the defective area onto the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching, without damaging the materials, and restitching in the required manner. 1/

1/ When making the above repairs, the ends of the stitching are not required to be backstitched.

3.3.2 Setting of Rivets.

3.3.2.1 Tubular rivets and caps. All rivets shall be securely and neatly set with a rivet cap and without causing damage to the webbing. Holes punched in the straps to receive blind rivets that attach the strap to the aluminum frame shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the rivet body so that the rivet must be forced through the hole in the strap.

3.3.2.2 Solid or tubular rivets without caps. All rivets shall be properly driven with heads flush against steel stampings. The ends of solid rivets shall be peened without burrs or sharp edges. The ends of tubular rivets shall be firmly clinched with even metal distribution.

3.3.3 Steel stampings. The steel stampings (L's, S's and T's) shall be securely riveted or bolted as shown on the applicable drawings and the flanges of the stampings shall be pressed down and fitted tightly against the adjacent parts.

3.3.4 Plug, end. End plugs shall be riveted, pinned or cemented into the bottom of the legs and both ends of the end rails to prevent removal. The adhesive, when used, shall be such, as recommended by the adhesive manufacturer for adherence of plastic to aluminum alloy.

3.4 Finish.

3.4.1 Aluminum alloy frame. Ends shall be cut clean and be free of sharp or rough edges. The rims of all holes shall be free of sharp or rough edges.

3.4.2 Plating. All steel stampings (L's, S's and T's) shall be zinc plated in accordance with type I, service condition 3 (SC3) of ASTM-B633.

3.5 Markings for identification.

3.5.1 Frame and cover. The identification marking shall be as specified on the applicable drawing.

3.6 Workmanship. Cloth components shall be clean and free of holes, cuts, tears, or cloth defects such as multiple floats or broken or missing yarns. Webbing and tapes shall contain no frayed or scalloped edges. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching and seam allowances shall be maintained with seams properly sewed so that no runoffs, twists, pleats or open seams shall result. Care shall be taken in sewing so that there shall be no needle chews. All thread ends shall be trimmed to 0.250 inch or

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less. Blind rivets shall be securely and neatly set. Metal components shall be free of burrs, sharp edges and corroded areas, and shall not be broken, malformed, or dented. The finished product shall also conform to the quality of product established by this specification and the occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality level.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his/her own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification for inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 3.1 and 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3 and 4.4.4. Any nonconformance shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with ASQ/ANSI-Z1.4.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be subjected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.2 In-process inspection. Inspection shall be made to determine that the following are as specified:

a. Holes punched to receive blind rivets (see 3.3.2.1).
b. Setting of solid or tubular rivets (see 3.3.2.2).
c. Setting of end plugs in bottom of legs and end rails of cots (see 3.3.4).

Whenever nonconformance is noted, correction shall be made to the items affected and the process. Parts which cannot be corrected shall be removed.

4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end items shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in units of cots. The sample unit shall be one cot. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5 for major defects and 15 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

4.4.4 End item dimensional examination. The end items shall be examined for conformance to the dimensions specified on the drawings. Only those dimensions that can be evaluated without damaging or disassembling the end items shall be examined. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of cots. The sample unit shall be one cot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

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TABLE I. End item visual defects.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Fabric	Any hole, except drill holes, cut, or tear	101	
	Broken or missing yarn, or open place clearly visible at normal inspection distance (approximately 3 feet)	102	
	Shade bar		201
Tape and webbings	Not firmly and tightly woven; edges frayed or scalloped	103	
	Multiple floats		202
	Any cut, hole, tear, or smash	104	
	Abrasion mark, slub, broken end, or pick		203
	Ends not fused as specified (where required)		204
Hardware (Bolts, nuts, washers, and rivets)	Broken	105	
	Malformed:		
	- fails to perform intended function	106	
	- but will perform intended function		205
	Any burr or sharp edge	107	
	Missing, damaged:		
	- one		206
	- two or more	108	
	Not type or size specified		207
	Any evidence of rust or corrosion	109	
	Bolt or nut loose, washer missing		208
	Rivet not securely set or neatly headed	110	
	Rivet length insufficient and peening or rolling as applicable	111	
End clips	Improperly clinched, i.e., webbing not flat at point of entrance into clips	112	
	Clinched excessively tight, cutting webbing or loosely clinched, i.e., clip becomes disengaged from webbing	113	
Steel stampings (L's, S's & T's)	Not riveted or bolted as specified on applicable drawings	114	
	Not fitted tightly against adjacent parts		209
	Not finished as specified	115	
	Any evidence of corrosion, exposed bare metal, or bar spots	116	
Seams and stitching	Open seam:		
	- for more than 0.250 inch but not more than 0.500 inch		210
	- for more than 0.500 inch	117	
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as "open" when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when one or more skipped or runoff stitches occur. On double stitched seams, a seam shall be classified as "open" when either one or both sides of a seam are open.		
	Raw edge:		
	- more than 0.750 inch but not more than 1.500 inches		211
	- more than 1.500 inches	118	

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TABLE I. End item visual defects. (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Seams and stitching (cont'd)	Thread break overstitched less than 1 inch		212
	Needle chew resulting in cut or tear: longer than 0.125 inch in length or larger than 0.125 inch in diameter	119	
	One or more required rows of stitch-inch omitted (except on boxstitching)	120	
Boxstitching	Incomplete:		
	- one row of stitching omitted		213
	- two or more rows of stitching omitted	121	
Seam type	Wrong seam type	122	
Stitch type	Wrong stitch type	123	
Stitch tension	Loose, resulting in an exposed bobbin thread for more than 2 inches		214
	Tight, as evidenced by puckering of fabric for more than 2 inches		215
Stitches per inch	Less than minimum specified		
	- one stitch		216
	- two or more stitches	124	
	One or more stitches in excess of maximum specified		217
	NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch at corners shall be classified as follows: a. Within the minor defect classification - no defect b. Within the major defect classification - minor defect		
Stitching margin; stitching gage	Not as specified		218
Stitching ends	Overstitched less than 1 inch (except when ends are held down by other stitching, turned under in a hem or where stitching is performed automatically)		219
	Secured with less than three tying, overlapping or backstitches when automatic stitching is performed		220
Hems	Twisted or pleated		221
	Constructed with partial turnunder when double turnunder is required		222
Securing patch (when required)	Missing	125	
Binding	Loosely applied but not exposing raw edge of material		223
	Loosely applied exposing raw edge of material	126	

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TABLE I. End item visual defects. (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Frame	Bent or deformed	127	
	Dented	128	
	Any sharp edge, burr, or sliver	129	
End rail	Hole for dowel plug missing, not as specified	130	
	Hole for spacer plug missing or not drilled as specified	131	
	Stay missing	132	
	Stay not firmly fixed with blind rivet	133	
Leg, long	Strap, buckle or end clip missing	134	
	Strap not securely fastened to leg	135	
End plug	Not securely fastened in place		224
	One missing		225
	More than one missing	136	
Spacer plug	Missing	137	
Dowel plug	Missing	138	
Assembly	Cot cannot be fully opened	139	
	Cot cannot be easily closed or compactly folded	140	
	Any component not material specified	141	
	Any component part or operation omitted (unless otherwise classified herein)	142	
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or misplaced		226
Cleanness	Grease or oil stains, thread ends not trimmed to 0.250 inch or less		227

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When packaging of material is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activities within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the military service's system commands. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

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6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that is helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The cot covered by this specification is for use in field camps and other temporary quarters.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition requirements should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. When a first article is require (see 3.1, 4.3 and 6.3).
c. Packaging requirements (see 5.1).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it should be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Insect net pole supports. Insect netting and wood pole supports conforming to A-A-55244 and MIL-P-17662, respectively, may be used on the cot covered by this specification.

6.5 Blind rivets. Blind rivet MIL-R-24243/3, part number M24243/3-B606, may meet the requirements of 3.2.1.

6.6 Subject term (key word) listing.

Collapsible bed
Collapsible frame
Field bed
Folding frame

6.7 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - GL
Navy - YD
Air Force - 84

Preparing activity:
DLA - CQ

(Project 7105-2025-001)

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MC

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